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Computing device rack and retaining system

Abstract

A computing device rack for housing a computing device. The rack comprises a frame to which a computing device is mountable, a retaining member mounted to the frame, and the retaining member having a latch that is movable relative to the frame, and an actuator movably coupled to the frame and the retaining member. Movement of the actuator relative to the frame and the retaining member from a first position to a second position deforms the retaining member to move the latch from an initial position to a final position relative to the frame, and thereby engages or disengages with the computing device that is mounted on the frame for locking or unlocking, respectively.

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Background/Summary

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) Disclosed herein relates to a computing device rack and a retaining system and in particular to a server rack and a computing system having server nodes mounted to a rack.

BACKGROUND

(2) Computing devices such as server nodes are mounted and secured to a server rack under a typical computer data room arrangement. To ensure proper position and connection of server nodes in a rack, there is a requirement to lock each server node to the rack during normal operation of the server nodes, and unlock and remove a server node from the server rack for maintenance and/or replacement. To optimize the available room space while reserving sufficient clearance surrounding the rack for maintenance, it is desirable to provide a computing system and a retaining apparatus capable of reliably locking each server node to a rack, and conveniently unlock a server node from the rack in case of need for maintenance.

SUMMARY

(3) In one aspect, the present disclosure provides a computing device rack for housing a computing device. The rack comprises a frame to which a computing device is mountable, a retaining member mounted to the frame, the retaining member having a latch that is movable relative to the frame, and an actuator movably coupled to the frame and the retaining member. Movement of the actuator relative to the frame and the retaining member from a first position to a second position deforms the retaining member to move the latch from an initial position to a final position relative to the frame, and thereby engages or disengages with the computing device that is mounted on the frame for locking or unlocking, respectively.

(4) In another aspect, the present disclosure provides a computing system. The computing system comprises a frame, a computing device detachably coupled to the frame, a retaining member mounted to the frame, the retaining member having a latch that is movable relative to the frame; and an actuator moveably coupled to the frame and the retaining member. Movement of the actuator from a first position to a second position deforms the retaining member to move the latch relative to the support portion from an initial position to a final position relative to the frame, and thereby engages or disengages with the computing device that is mounted on the frame for locking or unlocking, respectively.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF DRAWINGS

(1) The features of the embodiments will be more comprehensively understood in conjunction with the accompanying drawings, in which:

(2) FIG. 1 is a perspective view of a computing device rack according to one embodiment;

(3) FIG. 2 is a perspective view of a computer server system with one or more servers for mounting to a rack shown in FIG. 1;

(4) FIG. 3 is an exploded view of FIG. 1;

(5) FIG. 4 is a partial cross sectional view an example rack of FIG. 1;

(6) FIG. 5 is a partial enlarged view of portion 5 of FIG. 4;

(7) FIG. 6 is a partial exploded view of FIG. 3 showing an assembly of the retaining member and the actuator;

(8) FIG. 7 is an enlarged partial view of FIG. 3 showing the actuator in two positions;

(9) FIG. 8 is a partial enlarged view of portion 8 of FIG. 7;

(10) FIG. 9 is an enlarged top view of FIG. 8 showing the actuator at the first position;

(11) FIG. 10 is an enlarged top view of FIG. 8 showing the actuator at the second position;

(12) FIG. 11 is a perspective view showing the actuator in two positions compared in a side-by-side

view;

(13) FIG. 12 is a perspective view of a computing device rack according to another embodiment;

(14) FIG. 13 is a perspective view of a computer server system with one or more servers for mounting to a rack shown in FIG. 12;

(15) FIG. 14 is a partial exploded view of one example rack of FIG. 12;

(16) FIG. 15 is an enlarged partial view of FIG. 14;

(17) FIG. 16 is an enlarged partial perspective view of FIG. 15 showing two positions of the actuator;

(18) FIG. 17 is an enlarged top view of FIG. 16 showing the actuator at the first position;

(19) FIG. 18 is an enlarged top view of FIG. 16 showing the actuator at the second position;

(20) FIG. 19 is a perspective view of a computing device rack according to a further embodiment;

(21) FIG. 20 is a partial enlarged view of portion 20 of FIG. 19;

(22) FIG. 21 is a partial enlarged view of portion 21 of FIG. 19;

(23) FIG. 22 is an enlarged top view of FIG. 20 showing the actuator at the first position;

(24) FIG. 23 is an enlarged top view of FIG. 20 showing the actuator at the second position.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(25) Illustrated in FIGS. 1 to 11 is a computing system, such as a computer server system 50 and a computing device rack 100 according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. As shown in FIGS. 1 to 7, the computer server system 50 includes a rack 100 and one or more servers 80 removably coupled to the rack 100. The rack 100 comprises a frame 110 with one or more compartments 120 formed therein. A pair of sidewalls 122 and 124, a top plate 121 and a bottom plate 125 of the frame 110 enclose an internal space to form the compartment 120. Each compartment 120 is to receive and retain a server 80 therein. A retaining member 130 and an actuator 140 are mounted to an external side of on one of the sidewalls, e.g. sidewall 122. Server 80 is removable from the compartment 120 for maintenance and/or replacement, and inserted into the compartment 120 to perform normal computer operation after completion of maintenance and/or replacement.

(26) The retaining member 130 has a support portion 132, a latch 138 movably coupled to the frame 110, and a link portion 134 between the support portion 132 and the latch 138.

(27) The support portion 132 is mounted to the frame 110 by e.g. a fastener or by welding. Alternatively, the retaining member 130 may be integrally formed with the frame 110 by e.g. stamping from a single piece of metal plate. The latch 138 is fixedly coupled to or formed integral with the support portion 132 through the link portion 134. The retaining member 130 is made of resilient material e.g. steel or alloy with predetermined elastically deformable properties. The link portion 134 is therefore elastically deformable following which the latch 138 is movable relative to the support portion 132 and the sidewall 122.

(28) The sidewall 122 has an opening 128 formed thereon. The latch 138 is positioned to be in alignment with the opening 128, and is movable relative to the frame 110 between an initial position 138a and a final (deflected) position 138b. At the initial position, the latch 138 is placed to pass through the opening 128 and extended into the compartment 120. At the final position 138b, the latch 138 is moved out of the compartment 120 through the opening 128.

(29) As shown in FIGS. 6 and 7, the actuator 140 is movably coupled to the frame 110 and the retaining member 130. The actuator 140 is slidably coupled to the sidewall 122, by mounting screws or rivets 152 passing through elongated holes 142 formed on the actuator 140. The actuator 140 has an executing portion 144 positioned between the sidewall 122 and the retaining member 130. The actuator 140 is movable relative to the sidewall 122, between a first position 144a and a second position 144b, along a movement or actuating path 145 intersecting the link portion 134 of the retaining member 130.

(30) As shown in FIGS. 8, 9, 10 and 11 with further details, the actuator 140 at the first position 144a is depicted by reference number 140a and the actuator 140 at the second position 144b is

depicted by reference number **140b**, i.e. the actuator **140a**, **140b** shown in each of FIGS. **8**, **9**, **10** and **11** refer to the same actuator **140** as shown in FIGS. **1** to **7**, and at respective first position **144a** and second position **144b**. Upon the actuator **140a** being at the first position **144a**, there is left a space **135** between the link portion **134** and the sidewall **122**. Due to the resiliency of the retaining member **130**, the link portion **134** is biased to occupy the space **135** and the latch **138** is biased by the link portion **134** to extend into the compartment **120** through the opening **128** of the sidewall **122**.

(31) At the initial position **138a**, the latch **138** extends into the compartment **120** and engages a chassis **90** of a server **80**, to prevent the sever **80** from being removed from the compartment **120** and accordingly, the server **80** is secured in the compartment **120** by the latch **138**.

(32) In cases where the server **80** is to be removed from the compartment **120** for e.g. for maintenance, the actuator **140** is operated to move from the first position **144a** toward the second position **144b**, along the pushing direction **141**. Movement of the actuator **140** toward the second position **144b** engages the link portion **134** of the retaining member **130** and therefore deflects the link portion **134** by overcoming the resilient force of the retaining member **130**. Following the deflection of the link portion **134**, the latch **138** is moved from the initial position **138a** inside the compartment **120**, as shown in e.g. FIG. **9**, to a final position **138b** outside the compartment **120**, as shown in e.g. FIG. **10**, i.e. the latch **138** is retracted from the compartment **120** through the opening **128**.

(33) Upon the latch **138** being retracted from the compartment **120**, the server chassis **90** becomes disengaged from the latch **138** to unlock the server **80** such that the server **80** may be removed from the frame **110** for the purpose of maintenance and/or replacement.

(34) Upon completion of maintenance, the server **80** can be inserted into the compartment **120** to resume operation. The actuator **140** is moved from the second position **144b** back to the first position **144a** to vacate the space **135**. Due to the resiliency of the retaining member **130**, the biasing force of the retaining member **130** causes the link portion **134** to spring back to occupy the space **135** and to return the latch **138** to the initial position **138a** i.e. the latch **138** extends into the compartment **120** through the opening **128** and engages the chassis **90** to lock the server **80** in the compartment **120** of the frame **110**.

(35) The latch **138** may have a slanted edge **139** (FIG. **9**) facing an insertion direction **129** of the compartment **120**. In the process of the server **80** being inserted into the compartment **120**, the chassis **90** engages the slanted edge **139** to push the latch **138** out of the compartment **120**. After the stopper **92** of the chassis **90** passes over the latch **138**, the engagement between the chassis **90** and the slanted edge **139** is released to allow the latch **138** to spring back and placed in the compartment **120** to lock the server **80** to the frame **110**.

(36) In this regard, the latch **138** may be allowed to resume to the initial position **138a** while the compartment **120** is vacant, such that the compartment **120** is ready for receiving the server **80** and locking the server **80** in the compartment **120**.

(37) As the executing portion **144** is positioned between the sidewall **122** and the link portion **134** and biased by the link portion **134**, the actuator **140** is self-lockable to the frame **110** by the friction between the actuator **140** and the sidewall **122** and the friction between the actuator **140** and the retaining member **130**.

(38) Alternatively or additionally, as shown in FIG. **7**, the rack **100** may further include a resilient member e.g. a helical spring **170** coupled between the frame **110** and the actuator **140** to urge the actuator **140** toward the first position **140a**. The helical spring **170** exerts a force on the actuator **140** to pull the actuator **140** back to the first position **144a** after an external force pushing the actuator **140** toward the second position **144b** is removed by e.g. a user releasing the actuator **140**, the server **80** is removed from the compartment **120**.

(39) FIGS. **12** to **18** illustrate a computing system **60** according to another embodiment of the present disclosure. The computing system **60** includes a rack **200** and one or more servers **80**

removably coupled to the rack **200**. The rack **200** comprises a frame **210** with one or more compartments **220** formed therein. A pair of sidewalls **222** and **224**, a top plate **221** and a bottom plate **225** of the frame **210** enclose an internal space to form the compartment **220**. Each compartment **220** is to receive and retain a server **80** therein. Sidewall **222** includes a pair of panels **222a** and **222b** formed parallel to each other. A retaining member **230** and an actuator **240** are mounted to an external side of the sidewall **222** and between the pair of panels **222a** and **222b**. Server **80** is removable from the compartment **220** for maintenance and/or replacement, and inserted into the compartment **220** after the maintenance, to perform normal computing operation.

(40) The retaining member **230** has a support portion **232**, a latch **238** movably coupled to the frame **210**, a link portion **234** between the support portion **232** and the latch **238**, and a bearing portion **236** at an end of the retaining member **230** and connected to the latch **238**. The support portion **232** is mounted to the panel **222b** of sidewall **222**, by e.g. a fastener or by welding. Alternatively, the retaining member **230** may be integrally formed to the sidewall **222** by e.g. stamping from a single piece of metal plate. The latch **238** is fixedly coupled to or formed integral with the support portion **232**. The retaining member **230** is made of resilient material e.g. steel or alloy with elastically deformable properties. The link portion **234** is therefore elastically deformable following which the latch **138** is movable relative to the support portion **232** and the frame **210**.

(41) The panel **222a** of sidewall **222** has an opening **228** formed thereon. The latch **238** is movable relative to the frame **210** between an initial position **238a** and a final position **238b**. At the initial position, the latch **238** is placed outside the compartment **220**. At the final position **238b**, the latch **238** extends into the compartment **220** through the opening **228**.

(42) The actuator **240** is movably coupled to the frame **210** and the retaining member **230**. The actuator **240** is slidably coupled to the sidewall **222**. The actuator **240** has an executing portion **246** positioned to face the bearing portion **236** of the retaining member **230**. The actuator **240** is movable relative to the sidewall **222** between a first position **244a** and a second position **244b**, along a movement or actuating path **245** intersecting the link portion **234**.

(43) Shown in FIGS. **16**, **17** and **18** with further details, the actuator **240** at the first position **244a** is depicted by reference number **240a** and the actuator **240** at the second position **244b** is depicted by reference number **240b**, i.e. the actuator **240a**, **240b** shown in each of FIGS. **16** to **18** refer to the same actuator **240** as shown in FIGS. **12** to **15**, and at respective first position **244a** and second position **244b**.

(44) Upon the actuator **240** being at the first position **244a**, as shown in e.g. FIG. **17**, the actuator **240** and the retaining member **230** are disengaged from each other and accordingly, due to the resiliency of the retaining member **230**, the latch **238** is biased to the initial position **238a** at the external side of the sidewall **222**, at which, the latch **238** is outside the compartment **220**.

(45) After a server **80** is inserted into the compartment **220**, the actuator **240** is moved toward the retaining member **230**, by e.g. a user pushing the actuator **240**, to bring the executing portion **246** of the actuator **240** into engagement with the bearing portion **236** of the retaining member **230**. Further advancement of the actuator **240** toward the second position **244b**, as shown in FIG. **18**, results in the executing portion **246** of the actuator **240** abutting and urging against the bearing portion **236** of the retaining member **230** and accordingly, the actuator **240** deforms the link portion **234** to move the latch **238** away from the frame **210** to the final position **238b**, i.e. into the compartment **220** through an opening **228** formed on the panel **222a** of the sidewall **222**. By being placed in the compartment **220**, the latch **238** engages the chassis **90** to lock the server **80** in the compartment **220**. As shown in FIG. **16**, the actuator **240** may be locked at the second position **244b** by e.g. tightening the stem **247** to the track **227** on the panel **222a** of the sidewall **222**, to maintain the latch **238** at the final position **238b**.

(46) Backward movement of the actuator **240** from the second position **244b** to the first position **244a**, e.g. after the stem **247** is unlocked from the track **227**, releases the engagement of the

actuator **240** from the retaining member **230**. Due to the resiliency of the retaining member **230**, the biasing force of the retaining member **230** causes the latch **238** to spring back toward and return to the initial position **238a** and retracted from the compartment **220**, to release the engagement with the chassis **90** hence to unlock the server **80** from the compartment **220**.

(47) FIGS. **19** to **22** illustrate a computing system **70** according to a further embodiment of the present disclosure. The computing system **70** includes a rack **300** and one or more servers **80** removably coupled to the rack **300**. The rack **300** comprises a frame **310** with one or more compartments **320** formed therein. A pair of sidewalls **322** and **324**, a top plate **321** and a bottom plate **325** of the frame **310** enclose an internal space to form the compartment **320**. Sidewall **322** includes a pair of panels **322a** and **322b** formed parallel to each other. Each compartment **320** is to receive and retain a server **80** therein and between the pair of panels **322a** and **322b**. A retaining member **330** and an actuator **340** are mounted to an external side of the sidewall **322**. Server **80** is removable from the compartment **320** for maintenance and/or replacement, and inserted into the compartment **320** to perform normal computing operation.

(48) The retaining member **330** has a support portion **332**, a latch **338** movably coupled to the frame **310**, a link portion **334** between the support portion **332** and the latch **338**, and a bearing portion **336** at an end of the retaining member **330** and connected to the latch **338**. The support portion **332** is mounted to the panel **322b** of sidewall **322**, by e.g. a fastener or by welding. Alternatively, the retaining member **330** may be integrally formed to the sidewall **322** by e.g. stamping from a single piece of metal plate. The latch **338** is fixedly coupled to or formed integral with the support portion **332** through the link portion **334**. The retaining member **330** is made of resilient material e.g. steel or alloy with elastically deformable properties. The link portion **334** is therefore elastically deformable following which the latch **338** is movable relative to the support portion **332** and the frame **310**.

(49) The panel **322a** of sidewall **322** has an opening **328** formed thereon. The latch **338** is movable relative to the sidewall **322** between an initial position **338a** and a final position **338b**. At the initial position, the latch **338** extends into the compartment **320** through the opening **328**. At the final position **338b**, the latch **338** is placed outside the compartment **320**.

(50) The actuator **340** is movably coupled to the frame **310** and the retaining member **330**. The actuator **340** is slidably coupled to the sidewall **322**. The actuator **340** has an executing portion **346** connected to the bearing portion **336** of the retaining member **330**. The actuator **340** is movable relative to the sidewall **322** between a first position **344a** and a second position **344b**, along a movement or actuating path **345**.

(51) Shown in FIGS. **22** and **23** with further details, the actuator **340** at the first position **344a** is depicted by reference number **340a** and the actuator **340** at the second position **344b** is depicted by reference number **340b**, i.e. the actuator **340a**, **340b** shown in each of FIGS. **22** and **23** refer to the same actuator **340** as shown in FIGS. **19** to **21**, and at respective first position **344a** and **344b**.

(52) Upon the actuator **340** being at the first position **344a**, the latch **338** is released by the actuator **340** and acted by the resiliency of the link portion **334**, to remain at the initial position **338a**. At the initial position **338a**, the latch **338** extends into the compartment **320** through the opening **328** of the sidewall **320**, and engages a stopper **92** of the chassis **90** of server **80** placed in the compartment **320**. Due to the engagement of the latch **338** to the stopper **92** of the chassis **90**, the server **80** is locked in the compartment **320** i.e. removal of the server **80** from the compartment **320** is prevented by the latch **338**.

(53) In cases where the server **80** is to be removed from the compartment **320** for e.g. maintenance, the actuator **340** is pulled by a user along the actuating path **345**, from the first position **344a** as shown in FIG. **22**, toward the second position **344b** as shown in FIG. **23**.

(54) As the actuator **340** is connected to the retaining member **330** at the bearing portion **346**, movement of the actuator **340** toward the second position **344b** exerts a pulling force on the retaining member **330**. As the link portion **334** is resiliently deformable, the pulling force deforms

the link portion **334** following which, the latch **338** is moved out of the compartment **320** through the opening **328**. After the latch **338** is moved out of the compartment **320**, the chassis **90** is disengaged from the latch **338** and therefore, the server **80** can be removed from the compartment **320**.

(55) Thus, although illustrative example embodiments have been described herein with reference to the accompanying figures, it is to be understood that this description is not limiting and that various other changes and modifications may be effected therein by one skilled in the art without departing from the scope or spirit of the disclosure.

Claims

1. A computing device rack for housing a computing device, the computing device rack comprising: a frame to which the computing device is mountable; a retaining member mounted to the frame, the retaining member having a latch that is movable relative to the frame; and an actuator movably coupled to the frame and the retaining member, wherein movement of the actuator relative to the frame and the retaining member from a first position to a second position deforms the retaining member to move the latch from an initial position to a final position relative to the frame, and thereby engages or disengages with the computing device that is mounted on the frame for locking or unlocking, respectively, and wherein the retaining member is resiliently deformable and biases the latch toward the initial position, and the retaining member is substantially planar.
2. The computing device rack of claim 1, wherein at the initial position the latch is disposed in a compartment of the frame to lock a chassis of a computing device received in the compartment of the frame, and at the final position the latch is disposed outside the compartment to release the chassis from the frame.
3. The computing device rack of claim 2, wherein the retaining member has a link portion between a support portion and the latch, the frame has a sidewall onto which the support portion of the retaining member is mounted, wherein the actuator has an executing portion engageable to the retaining member, and the executing portion is positioned between the sidewall and the link portion.
4. The computing device rack of claim 3, wherein the executing portion of the actuator is self-lockable to the frame upon being placed between the sidewall and the link portion.
5. The computing device rack of claim 3, wherein the sidewall has an opening formed thereon, wherein at the initial position the latch extends into the compartment through the opening.
6. The computing device rack of claim 3, wherein the actuator is movable along an actuating path parallel to the sidewall of the compartment and movement of the latch between the initial position and the final position is along a direction intersecting the actuating path.
7. The computing device rack of claim 1, wherein upon movement of the actuator from the second position to the first position, the biasing force of the retaining member causes the latch to return to the initial position.
8. The computing device rack of claim 1, wherein the actuator has an executing portion engageable to a bearing portion of the retaining member, and engagement of the actuator with the bearing portion of the retaining member moves the latch away from the frame.
9. The computing device rack of claim 1, wherein at the initial position the latch is disposed outside a compartment of the frame to unlock the computing device received in the compartment from the frame, and at the final position the latch is disposed in the compartment to lock the computing device to the frame.
10. The computing device rack of claim 1, further comprising a resilient member coupled to the frame and the actuator to urge the actuator toward the first position.
11. A computing system comprising: a frame; a computing device detachably coupled to the frame;

a retaining member mounted to the frame, the retaining member having a latch that is movable relative to the frame; and an actuator moveably coupled to the frame and the retaining member, wherein movement of the actuator relative to the frame and the retaining member from a first position to a second position deforms the retaining member to move the latch from an initial position to a final position relative to the frame, and thereby engages or disengages with the computing device that is mounted on the frame for locking or unlocking, respectively, and wherein the retaining member is resiliently deformable and biases the latch toward the initial position, and the retaining member is substantially planar.

12. The computing system of claim 11, wherein at the initial position the latch is disposed in a compartment of the frame to lock the computing device received in the compartment of the frame, and at the final position the latch is disposed outside of the compartment to release the computing device from the frame.

13. The computing system of claim 12, wherein the retaining member has a link portion between a support portion and the latch, the frame has a sidewall onto which the support portion of the retaining member is mounted, wherein the actuator has an executing portion engageable to the retaining member, and the executing portion is positioned between the sidewall and the link portion.

14. The computing system of claim 11, wherein upon movement of the actuator from the second position to the first position, the biasing force of the retaining member causes the latch to return to the initial position.

15. The computing system of claim 11, wherein the computing device has a stopper formed thereon and wherein at the initial position the latch engages the stopper to lock the computing device in the compartment.

16. The computing system of claim 15, wherein the frame has a sidewall to which the retaining member is mounted and the sidewall has an opening formed thereon, wherein at the initial position the latch extends into the compartment through the opening to engage the stopper of the computing device to lock the computing device in the compartment.

17. The computing system of claim 16, wherein the actuator is movable along an actuating path parallel to the sidewall of the compartment and movement of the latch between the initial position and the final position is along a direction transversal to the sidewall of the compartment.

18. The computing system of claim 11, wherein the actuator has an executing portion engageable to a bearing portion of the retaining member, and engagement of the actuator with the bearing portion of the retaining member moves the latch away from the frame.
